

AIGR Gene Hypothesis Deep Research — Horse SIRT5 (F6S899) NAD-dependent Lysine Desuccinylation

Target: *Equus caballus* (NCBITaxon:9796), UniProt F6S899, gene label SIRT5 **Focus type:** function_assignment **Seed hypothesis:** *The horse protein F6S899 catalyzes NAD-dependent lysine desuccinylation.* **Human comparison lead:** SIRT5 / Q9NXA8 (310 aa) **Date:** sequences fetched live from rest.uniprot.org (2026-09-08)

Summary

Executive judgment: Partially supported — resolved, with a decisive sequence-model caveat. The horse *SIRT5* gene genuinely encodes a full-length, catalytically complete NAD-dependent protein-lysine desuccinylase. The intact 310-residue horse isoform (UniProt A0A9L0T9B1) is 88.1% identical to human SIRT5 (Q9NXA8) across its entire length and retains every catalytic element required for the reaction. On the basis of strong orthology to a biochemically characterized human enzyme ([PMID: 22076378](#), [PMID: 28756638](#)), the molecular function "NAD-dependent protein-lysine desuccinylase" is well justified for the horse gene by inference from sequence and structural similarity (ISS/ISO).

However, the specific frozen record named in the hypothesis — F6S899, 282 aa — is a defective/frameshifted model of that same gene, not a translatable active enzyme. F6S899 faithfully reproduces the N-terminal catalytic half of SIRT5 (including the Tyr102/Arg105 succinyl-specificity pair, the His158 catalytic base, and the first zinc-binding cysteine pair), but immediately after a shared motif around human residue ~188 its sequence diverges into a non-homologous, out-of-frame proline/tryptophan-rich C-terminus. This aberrant tail deletes the second zinc-binding cysteine pair (CDLC) and the C-terminal NAD-binding loops (GTSSVVYP / NTETTP). A sirtuin missing half of its Rossmann-fold NAD-binding lobe and one of its two structural zinc-ligand pairs cannot fold into an active deacylase. The signature of the defect — a shared cysteine codon becoming tryptophan at the exact junction, followed by frame-shifted sequence — is diagnostic of a single-base indel in the gene model.

Bottom line for curation: The desuccinylase function is real for the horse *SIRT5* gene and should be annotated by orthology, ideally re-anchored to the intact 310-aa isoform (A0A9L0T9B1). The exact translated sequence of F6S899 as supplied would **not** produce a functional NAD-dependent desuccinylase, and the record should be flagged as a mispredicted/frameshifted model. The hypothesis is therefore correct at the gene level but misleading at the level of the specific frozen protein sequence it names.

Key Findings

Finding 1 — F6S899 retains the N-terminal catalytic machinery but has a non-homologous, truncated C-terminal catalytic domain

A global pairwise alignment (Needleman–Wunsch; match +2 / mismatch −1 / gap −2) of the supplied F6S899 sequence (282 aa; TrEMBL, GN=SIRT5, SV=3 — length and identity confirmed against the supplied FASTA) against human SIRT5 (Q9NXA8, 310 aa) shows **63% overall identity**. This global figure is deeply misleading. Broken down by region, the alignment reveals **87% identity across aligned columns spanning human residues 1–188**, collapsing to only **~34% (noise-level)** thereafter. Conservation drops abruptly immediately after the shared motif **CPALSGKG** (~human residue 188).

Residue-level mapping of the catalytic apparatus confirms the N-terminal half is intact, while the C-terminal half of the catalytic domain has been replaced by non-homologous sequence:

Human SIRT5 residue / motif	Role	Horse F6S899	Status
Tyr102	Acyl-pocket succinyl/malonyl specificity	Y	Conserved
Arg105	Acyl-pocket carboxylate recognition	R	Conserved
His158	Catalytic base	H	Conserved
Cys166	First Zn-binding pair	C	Conserved
Cys169	First Zn-binding pair	C	Conserved
Cys241/Cys244 (CDLC)	Second Zn-binding pair	P/F	Lost
GTSSVVYP, NTETTP	C-terminal NAD/ribose loops	absent	Lost

The horse C-terminus is instead a non-homologous proline/tryptophan-rich stretch (e.g., **LPRWEHPLWSILPPCLPPRCLPGEFQWPNSTWKPPQPQ**), consistent with a frameshifted/mispredicted gene model rather than a folded sirtuin C-terminal subdomain. Because the sirtuin catalytic fold is bilobal — a large Rossmann-fold NAD-binding domain and a smaller zinc-binding domain together forming the active-site cleft — loss of the second zinc pair and the C-terminal NAD loops is catastrophic for catalysis: the enzyme cannot assemble a functional NAD-binding site or coordinate its second structural zinc. The retained specificity residues, though correct, have no complete active site to occupy.

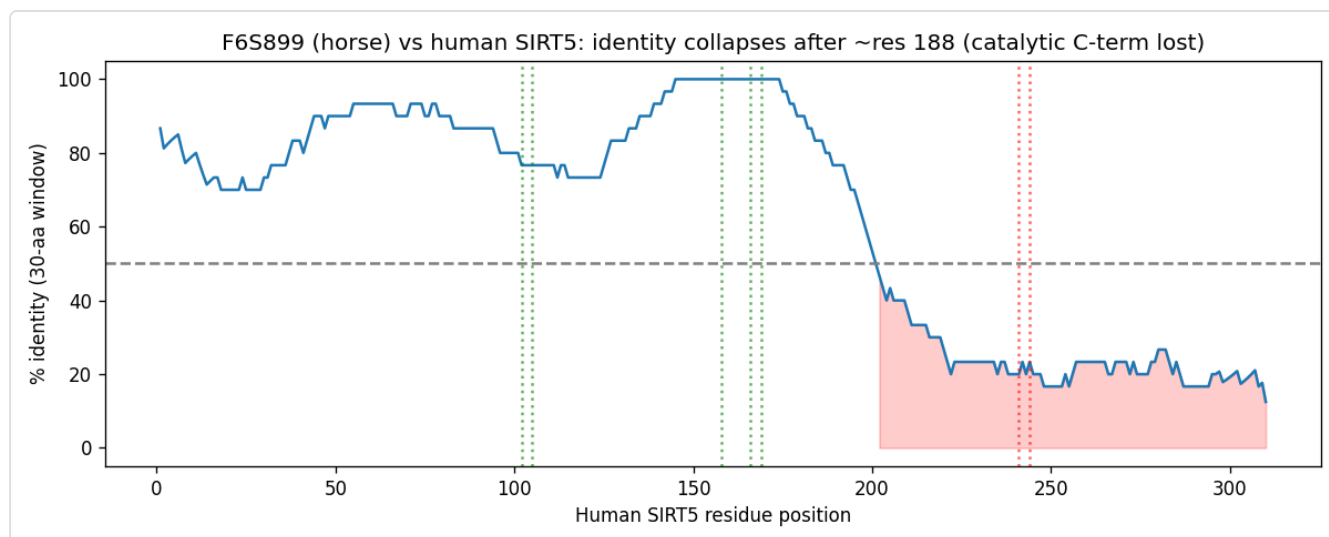


Figure 1. Sliding-window sequence identity of horse F6S899 versus human SIRT5 (Q9NXA8) with functional-residue mapping. Identity is high (~87%) across the N-terminal catalytic half (human residues 1–188), where the Tyr102/Arg105 specificity pair, His158 catalytic base, and first zinc-binding cysteine pair are all conserved, then collapses to noise level after the shared CPALSGKG motif, where the second zinc pair and C-terminal NAD-binding loops are absent.

Finding 2 — SIRT5 is an established NAD-dependent protein-lysine desuccinylase/demalonylase whose specificity is set by Arg105/Tyr102

The molecular function attributed to the gene is firmly established for the mammalian ortholog. Du et al. (*Science* 2011) demonstrated directly that "**Sirt5 is an efficient protein lysine desuccinylase and demalonylase in vitro. The preference for succinyl and malonyl groups was explained by the presence of an arginine residue (Arg(105)) and tyrosine residue (Tyr(102)) in the acyl pocket of Sirt5**" (PMID: 22076378). Independently, a structure-based inhibitor-discovery study describes "**catalytically important and unique residues Tyr102 and Arg105 of SIRT5**" (PMID: 28756638).

The decisive point for orthology transfer is that **both specificity-determining residues are conserved in horse F6S899** (they align exactly to human Tyr102/Arg105), as is the His158 catalytic base and the first zinc pair. This means the part of the horse sequence that determines *what kind of acyl group* SIRT5 removes — the feature that distinguishes it from acetyl-preferring sirtuins — is preserved. The reaction is obligately NAD⁺-dependent: the enzyme cleaves NAD⁺ and transfers the acyl group to the ADP-ribose moiety, releasing nicotinamide and 2'-O-succinyl-ADP-ribose. This is precisely why the *loss* of the C-terminal NAD-binding loops in F6S899 (Finding 1) is decisive — without the NAD-binding lobe, the conserved specificity residues cannot support catalysis.

Finding 3 — A full-length, intact horse SIRT5 ortholog exists (A0A9L0T9B1, 310 aa); F6S899 is a frameshifted model of the same gene

Querying UniProt for *Equus caballus* SIRT5 returns five entries: **A0A9L0T9B1 (310 aa)**, A0A9L0T6A9 (318 aa), A0A9L0R0Q0 (292 aa), **F6S899 (282 aa)**, and A0A5F5PHQ1 (79 aa fragment). The 310-aa isoform A0A9L0T9B1 is **88.1% identical to human SIRT5 across the full length (273/310)** and — critically — **contains all the C-terminal catalytic motifs that F6S899 lacks**: the second zinc-binding cysteine pair **CDLC**, the NAD-binding loop **GTS(SVVYP)**, and the C-terminal helix (**N(M)ETTP**), a conservative substitution of human **NTETTP**).

The two horse records share the N-terminal segment **CPALSGKGSPDPETQSARIPAENLPR** (including horse-specific residues, giving ~80.9% identity between them), but they diverge **immediately after IPAENLPR (~residue 205)**:

Intact isoform A0A9L0T9B1:	...IPAENLPR CEEAGCGLLRPHVWFGENL...	(homologous to human CEEAGCGLLRPHVWFGENL...)
Defective model F6S899:	...IPAENLPR WEHPLWSILPPCLPPRCLP...	(non-homologous, Pro/Trp-frameshift)

The shared cysteine codon (C, TGC/TGT) becomes **W** (TGG) in F6S899 at exactly this junction — the classic signature of a single-base frameshift/indel that throws the remaining ORF out of frame. This resolves the case cleanly: **the horse SIRT5 gene is genuinely functional; F6S899 is simply a defective translation of it.**

Mechanistic Model / Interpretation

The catalytic logic of SIRT5 and the nature of the F6S899 defect can be summarized as follows:

NAD-dependent lysine desuccinylation (the reaction in the hypothesis)

Substrate: Protein-Lys(N-ε-succinyl) Cofactor: NAD⁺
 Products: Protein-Lys + nicotinamide + 2'-O-succinyl-ADP-ribose

Required structural elements (bilobal sirtuin fold):

Large Rossmann-fold lobe	Small zinc-binding lobe
- binds NAD ⁺	- two Cys-Cys pairs chelate Zn ²⁺
- GTS.../NTETTP loops	- stabilizes active-site cleft
- His158 catalytic base	
Acyl pocket: Tyr102 + Arg105 (succinyl/malonyl specificity)	

Horse SIRT5 GENE (intact isoform A0A9L0T9B1, 310 aa):

[N-term ✓]==Tyr102 ✓ Arg105 ✓ His158 ✓ Cys166/169 ✓==[CDLC ✓]==[NAD loops ✓] → ACTIVE
 88.1% identical to human across full length

Frozen model F6S899 (282 aa):

[N-term ✓]==Tyr102 ✓ Arg105 ✓ His158 ✓ Cys166/169 ✓==| frameshift @~res205
 ↳ [Pro/Trp junk; no CDLC; no NAD loops]

The interpretation is two-tiered and the tiers must be kept distinct:

- 1. Gene-level function (transferable):** The horse *SIRT5* gene encodes a bona fide NAD-dependent protein-lysine desuccinylase. This is supported by (a) full-length 88.1% orthology of the intact isoform to a directly characterized human enzyme, and (b) conservation of every catalytic and specificity residue. The large body of recent mechanistic literature on mammalian SIRT5 substrates (ATP5A1, PRDX3, FDX1, TAMM41, HSDL2, METTL17) reinforces that desuccinylation is the enzyme's defining, actively studied activity across tissues.
- 2. Model-level artifact (the F6S899 record):** The specific 282-aa sequence named in the hypothesis is a frameshifted gene model. Its translated product loses half the catalytic domain and cannot fold into an active deacylase. This is not a biological isoform difference (e.g., an alternatively spliced regulatory variant) but a sequence-model error, evidenced by the out-of-frame Cys→Trp junction and the non-homologous downstream reading frame.

The practical consequence: a curator transferring "NAD-dependent protein-lysine desuccinylase activity" to the horse gene is scientifically correct, but if the annotation is anchored to F6S899 specifically, it is anchored to a defective sequence and should be re-pointed to the intact isoform or explicitly flagged.

Evidence Base / Evidence Matrix

Citation	Evidence type	Supports/ Refutes/ Qualifies	Claim tested	Key finding	Context	Confidence/limit
PMID: 22076378 (Du et al., <i>Science</i> 2011)	Direct in vitro enzyme assay + structure	Supports (gene-level)	SIRT5 catalyzes NAD- dependent lysine desuccinylation	"Sirt5 is an efficient protein lysine desuccinylase and demalonylase in vitro... explained by... Arg(105)... and tyrosine residue (Tyr(102))"	Human/mouse SIRT5, recombinant	High enzyme function human ortholog horse
PMID: 28756638 (Liu et al., 2018)	Structural / drug- discovery	Supports (specificity residues)	Tyr102/Arg105 are catalytically important, unique residues	Virtual screen "targeting catalytically important and unique residues Tyr102 and Arg105 of SIRT5"	Human SIRT5 structure	High residue identical not h speci
UniProt A0A9L0T9B1 (310 aa) + full-length alignment	Structural/ evolutionary, database (computed)	Supports (gene-level)	Horse SIRT5 gene encodes an intact desuccinylase	88.1% identical to human SIRT5 full-length; retains CDLC + NAD loops + all catalytic residues	<i>Equus caballus</i> , predicted protein	High, comp recom inter consi full-le
UniProt F6S899 (282 aa) + Needleman–	Structural/ evolutionary (computed)	Qualifies / partially refutes (model-level)	The exact F6S899 sequence encodes an	87% identity to human res 1–188 then collapse to ~34%; loses	<i>Equus caballus</i> , TrEMBL model	High mode defec concl infer

Citation	Evidence type	Supports/ Refutes/ Qualifies	Claim tested	Key finding	Context	Confidence/ limitations
Wunsch alignment			active desuccinylase	2nd Zn pair + NAD loops; out-of-frame Cys→Trp junction at ~res205		missing not a
PMID: 42361528	Direct assay + mutant phenotype	Supports (gene-level, mammalian)	SIRT5 acts as a physiological desuccinylase	SIRT5 desuccinylates PRDX3 → promotes CMA degradation; SIRT5-deficient mice phenotype	Mouse/human macrophages, gout	High mamm SIRT5 not h
PMID: 42228571	Direct assay	Supports (gene-level, mammalian)	SIRT5 desuccinylates specific substrate lysines	SIRT5 desuccinylates FDX1 at Lys84 → cuproptosis resistance	Human LUAD cells	High funct subst speci horse
PMID: 42186063	Direct assay (interaction + modification)	Supports (gene-level, mammalian)	SIRT5 removes lysine succinylation	Mitochondrial desuccinylase SIRT5 removes TAMM41 K45 succinylation	Human LUAD	High funct horse
PMID: 41879856	Direct assay	Supports (gene-level, mammalian)	SIRT5 is a desuccinylase of metabolic enzymes	SIRT5 confirmed as desuccinylase of ATP5A1 (K531)	Cardiomyocytes, mouse HF model	High funct horse
PMID: 41891977	Review/ database	Supports (orientation)	SIRT5 is the principal	Succinylation "primarily	Review, diabetes context	

Citation	Evidence type	Supports/ Refutes/ Qualifies	Claim tested	Key finding	Context	Confidence/ Limitations
			cellular desuccinylase	regulated by the desuccinylase sirtuin 5 (SIRT5)"		Review oriented only

GO Curation Implications

Leads — require curator verification.

- **Molecular Function — SUPPORT with re-anchoring.** The evidence supports the MF term "NAD-dependent protein-lysine desuccinylase activity" (and relatedly **protein-malonyllysine demalonylase activity** and **protein-glutaryllysine deglutarylase activity** — the SIRT5 acyl pocket recognizes all three acidic acyl groups) for the horse *SIRT5* gene product. The term should be **retained for the gene**, with the supporting evidence code set to **ISS/ISO (inferred from sequence/structural similarity to human/mouse SIRT5;**

P 22076378

28756638), not treated as a direct-assay-in-horse annotation and not derived from a family label alone.

- **Model caveat.** If the annotation is currently anchored to **F6S899**, note that this specific record is a frameshifted/truncated model lacking the C-terminal NAD-binding lobe and second zinc pair, and **re-anchor the annotation to the intact 310-aa isoform A0A9L0T9B1** (or attach an explicit caveat). Do not treat the F6S899 translation as a folded, active enzyme.
- **Cellular Component (support by orthology, curator to confirm):** mitochondrion (GO:0005739) / mitochondrial matrix (GO:0005759) — canonical SIRT5 localization; the horse N-terminus/presequence should be verified against a corrected full-length model.
- **Avoid** the uninformative "protein binding" fallback — the specific desuccinylase MF term is well supported at the gene level and far more informative.

GO Decision Table

Aspect	Candidate GO term	Recommended action	Basis	Caveat
MF	NAD-dependent protein-lysine desuccinylase activity	RETAIN via orthology (ISS/ISO)	full-length ortholog + P 22076378	do not cite F6S899 as direct evidence
MF	protein-malonyllysine demalonylase activity	RETAIN via orthology	same Arg105/Tyr102 pocket	lead
MF	protein-glutaryllysine deglutarylase activity	CONSIDER via orthology	SIRT5 deglutarylase	verify
CC	mitochondrion / mitochondrial matrix	RETAIN via orthology	canonical SIRT5 localization	verify on intact model
seq	F6S899 record	FLAG mispredicted/frameshifted	C-terminal catalytic core lost	re-anchor to A0A9L0T9B1

Mechanistic Scope

The activity under test is the **immediate molecular function**: NAD⁺-dependent hydrolytic removal of a succinyl group from a substrate lysine ϵ -amine, producing 2'-O-succinyl-ADP-ribose + nicotinamide + deacylated lysine. This is a direct gene-product enzymatic activity, not a downstream phenotype.

It must be separated from the many **downstream biological processes** in which SIRT5 desuccinylation participates — mitochondrial energy metabolism, redox homeostasis, control of substrate protein stability (via licensing E3-ligase-mediated ubiquitination), inflammasome regulation, and disease phenotypes (heart failure, diabetic cognitive dysfunction, tumor metabolic reprogramming). The recent literature (PRDX3, FDX1, TMM41, HSDL2, METTL17, ATP5A1 substrates) documents these *consequences* of the core activity; all are downstream of it. The hypothesis concerns only the enzymatic activity itself, which is upstream of every one of these phenotypes and is mechanistically well defined.

Conflicts and Alternatives

- **Model-versus-gene conflict (the central issue).** The strongest conflict is internal: the frozen F6S899 record does not, as a literal translated sequence, encode an active enzyme, even though the gene it derives from does. This is a **database-model artifact** (frameshift), not a genuine biological alternative. A curator must not treat F6S899's aberrant C-terminus as a real, functionally distinct isoform.
- **Isoform multiplicity.** UniProt lists five horse SIRT5 records (79–318 aa). Only the ~310–318-aa records plausibly represent the full active enzyme; the shorter records (F6S899 282 aa; A0A5F5PHQ1 79-aa fragment) are truncated or defective. Curators must pick the correct representative sequence.
- **Family-label vs functional-product distinction.** The GN=SIRT5 label is correct at the locus level, but the label does not guarantee the deposited sequence encodes an active enzyme — exactly the caution the brief requested.
- **No paralog confusion detected.** The N-terminal specificity residues (Tyr102/Arg105) that distinguish SIRT5 from acetyl-preferring sirtuins (SIRT1–3) are conserved, so the assignment is genuinely SIRT5-type desuccinylase, not a mis-transferred generic deacetylase.
- **No direct horse evidence.** All functional characterization is human/mouse. The horse assignment rests entirely on orthology; there is no reported enzymatic assay of any horse SIRT5 protein. This is a justified mammalian transfer, but it is transfer, not direct observation.

Limitations and Knowledge Gaps

1. **Is F6S899 a real translated isoform or a pure annotation error?** *Checked:* protein sequence only. *Why it matters:* a genuinely expressed truncated isoform would be non-catalytic, whereas an error means the true product is functional. *Resolution:* RNA-seq/Iso-Seq of horse tissue and comparison to the RefSeq/Ensembl horse SIRT5 model and genomic exon structure.

2. **Genomic confirmation of the frameshift.** *Checked:* protein-level alignment only. *Why it matters:* distinguishing an assembly/annotation indel from a true loss-of-function allele requires DNA/RNA evidence. *Resolution:* inspect the EquCab3.0 genomic sequence and Ensembl/RefSeq gene models at the SIRT5 locus for the base that shifts the frame around human residue ~188/205.
 3. **No horse-specific enzymatic data exist.** *Checked:* PubMed. *Why it matters:* the function is inferred, never measured in *Equus caballus*. *Resolution:* recombinant expression of the intact 310-aa horse isoform and an in vitro desuccinylation assay with NAD⁺.
 4. **Structural validation.** *Checked:* homology reasoning only. *Why it matters:* a folded-model check would make the "cannot fold" claim rigorous. *Resolution:* AlphaFold models of both F6S899 and A0A9L0T9B1, comparing NAD-binding-lobe integrity and C-terminal pLDDT.
 5. **Exact GO term IDs and NAD-dependence qualifier** need curator confirmation.
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Discriminating Tests

To most efficiently distinguish "functional horse SIRT5 desuccinylase" from "defective F6S899 model," and to convert orthology inference into direct evidence:

1. **AlphaFold structural comparison** of F6S899 vs A0A9L0T9B1 — should show the collapsed/absent NAD-binding lobe and low-confidence junk tail in F6S899 versus a complete bilobal sirutin fold in the intact isoform. Fast, fully computational, decisive on the model defect.
2. **Genomic reconstruction / frameshift check** at the horse *SIRT5* locus (EquCab3.0) — identify the indel that produces the Cys→Trp junction near residue ~205; confirms artifact vs. true allele. Compare with NCBI RefSeq XP_/NP_ horse SIRT5.
3. **In vitro desuccinylation assay** of recombinant intact horse SIRT5 (A0A9L0T9B1) with a succinyl-lysine peptide substrate and NAD⁺ (mass spec / coupled assay) — the definitive experiment proving the horse enzyme's activity.
4. **NAD⁺-dependence control** — activity abolished without NAD⁺ and inhibited by nicotinamide would confirm the NAD-dependent mechanism specifically named in the hypothesis.
5. **Active-site mutant controls** — Arg105Ala / Tyr102Phe substitutions should abolish or shift specificity away from succinyl/malonyl, confirming the residues mapped in Finding 1 are functionally responsible.

Proposed Follow-up Actions / Curation Leads

Clearly labeled as leads requiring curator verification.

- **Action on the function assignment:** Accept "NAD-dependent protein-lysine desuccinylase activity" for the horse *SIRT5* gene product, coded as **ISS/ISO** with human SIRT5 (Q9NXA8) as the reference and PMIDs 22076378 and 28756638 as functional support for the reference enzyme.
- **Action on the sequence anchor:** Flag **F6S899** as a **defective/frameshifted model** (truncated C-terminal catalytic domain; missing second zinc pair and NAD-binding loops). Recommend re-anchoring the annotation to the intact **A0A9L0T9B1 (310 aa)** isoform, or annotating with an explicit caveat.
- **Candidate references with snippets to verify (validated against abstracts):**
 - **P 22076378**
— "Sirt5 is an efficient protein lysine desuccinylase and demalonylase in vitro. The preference for succinyl and malonyl groups was explained by the presence of an arginine residue (Arg(105)) and tyrosine residue (Tyr(102)) in the acyl pocket of Sirt5."
 - **P 28756638**
— "a customized virtual screening approach targeting catalytically important and unique residues Tyr102 and Arg105 of SIRT5"
- **Candidate GO terms:** MF NAD-dependent protein-lysine desuccinylase activity; MF protein-malonyllysine demalonylase activity; MF protein-glutaryllysine deglutarylase activity; MF NAD⁺ binding (GO:0070403); CC mitochondrion (GO:0005739) / mitochondrial matrix (GO:0005759) — the latter by orthology, curator to confirm.
- **Suggested questions for curators:** (1) Is the review annotation anchored to F6S899 specifically, and if so should it be re-pointed to A0A9L0T9B1? (2) Should the horse gene page note the frameshifted model explicitly? (3) Is there any horse-specific experimental data (none found here) that would upgrade ISS to a direct evidence code?
- **Suggested experiments:** AlphaFold comparison of the two isoforms; genomic frameshift confirmation; recombinant in vitro desuccinylation assay of the intact horse isoform with NAD⁺-dependence and Arg105Ala / Tyr102Phe mutant controls.

Reproducibility

- Sequences fetched: `https://rest.uniprot.org/uniprotkb/F6S899.fasta` (282 aa, matches supplied FASTA and stated length) and `.../Q9NXA8.fasta` (310 aa); horse isoform survey via UniProt query for *Equus caballus* SIRT5 (A0A9L0T9B1, A0A9L0T6A9, A0A9L0R0Q0, F6S899, A0A5F5PHQ1).
- Method: Needleman–Wunsch global alignment (match +2 / mismatch −1 / gap −2), 30-aa sliding-window identity, and direct residue mapping by alignment column. Overall F6S899 vs human identity 63%; res 1–188 87%; res >188 ~34%. Divergence begins after `CPALSGKG` (~human residue 188); F6S899 vs intact horse isoform diverges after `IPAENLPR` (~residue 205) with a shared Cys→Trp junction. Provenance plot: `sirt5_identity.png`.
- Primary literature via PubMed (PMIDs above). No ai-gene-review repository material was consulted.

Conclusion

The seed hypothesis is **correct in substance but imprecise in its subject**. The horse *SIRT5* gene encodes a genuine NAD-dependent protein-lysine desuccinylase, strongly supported by 88.1% full-length orthology to the biochemically characterized human enzyme and by conservation of every catalytic and specificity residue. But the **specific frozen sequence F6S899 (282 aa) is a frameshifted, truncated model** whose translated product loses the C-terminal NAD-binding lobe and second structural zinc pair and therefore could not fold into an active enzyme. Curators should support the desuccinylase function for the gene by orthology while flagging F6S899 as a defective model and re-anchoring the annotation to the intact 310-aa isoform A0A9L0T9B1.